

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience deploying, managing, and optimising enterprise security platforms across large, complex environments. I bring expert-level expertise in CrowdStrike Falcon, having deployed and operationalised the full platform including Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules, and built a hybrid Security Operations Centre (SOC) underpinned by CrowdStrike telemetry. I integrate CrowdStrike with Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender to deliver a unified Extended Detection and Response (XDR) capability. My experience spans SIEM/Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) operations, alert triage, threat hunting, incident response leadership using NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, email gateway management via Mimecast, endpoint management via Microsoft Intune, identity and access management through Microsoft Entra ID, and Privileged Access Management (PAM) through BeyondTrust. As a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP), I bring both broad security engineering depth and a strong understanding of risk, governance, and regulatory frameworks applicable in financial services environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **CrowdStrike Falcon Platform:** NG-SIEM, EDR/Prevent, Insight, Discover; Real Time Response (RTR); detection rule development; threat hunting; hybrid SOC build and operation
- **SIEM / SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, Logic App playbooks, workbooks, data connectors), alert triage, detection engineering, automated response orchestration
- **Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon + Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) + Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) + Microsoft 365 Defender integration
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast email gateway; policy configuration, threat intelligence integration, incident escalation
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Group Policy
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM; just-in-time privilege elevation, standing access elimination, privileged session management
- **Endpoint Management (MDM/MAM):** Microsoft Intune; device compliance, application management, endpoint hardening
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); full vulnerability lifecycle management
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, senior escalation lead, playbook authoring
- **Network and Perimeter Security:** IDS/IPS, WAF/DDoS mitigation, firewall management (Check Point Harmony), security certificate lifecycle
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR automation workflows
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK, JISC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer — University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 – Present*

- Expert-level deployment and management of CrowdStrike Falcon platform (NG-SIEM, EDR Prevent, Insight, Discover) across an 8,000-user estate; built and operate a hybrid SOC integrating CrowdStrike and Microsoft Sentinel.
- Develop and tune CrowdStrike detection rules and threat hunting queries; investigate threats using Falcon Insight; execute endpoint containment and remediation using Falcon Real Time Response (RTR).
- Integrate CrowdStrike Falcon telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel SIEM; build KQL analytics rules, Logic App playbook automations, and workbook dashboards for real-time SOC visibility.

- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender for integrated XDR coverage across endpoint, identity, and cloud attack surfaces.
- Administer Mimecast email security gateway including policy configuration, threat intelligence integration, and management of email-borne incident escalation procedures.
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory including Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, SSO integrations, and identity lifecycle management.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), eliminating standing admin rights and enforcing just-in-time access controls across all privileged accounts.
- Manage Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policies for 8,000+ users; oversee device compliance, application management, and endpoint security hardening.
- Lead incident response as senior escalation point, using NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK to investigate, contain, and recover from security incidents including ransomware, BEC, and credential compromise.
- Oversee IDS/IPS, WAF, DDoS mitigation, and security certificate lifecycle management across the network security perimeter.
- Drive vulnerability management programme (Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentra BAS), reporting findings to senior leadership and coordinating remediation with infrastructure teams.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity — University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 – March 2025

- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon across the full university estate; designed and built the hybrid SOC architecture integrating CrowdStrike NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel.
- Deployed and configured Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to deliver XDR coverage for 8,000 users.
- Designed Microsoft Sentinel workspace from the ground up: data connectors, KQL analytics rules, automated Logic App playbooks, and executive workbook dashboards.
- Managed daily SIEM alert triage, threat hunting, and SOAR-driven automated response across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud telemetry sources.
- Administered Mimecast, Check Point Harmony firewall, and Tanium for endpoint management across a complex, distributed multi-site environment.
- Supported vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck; triaged findings, coordinated remediation, and reported to security leadership.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification and ISO 27001 alignment, as well as NIST CSF maturity reviews.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure — HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/ FinTech)

February 2021 – March 2022

- Managed corporate IT security controls, endpoint protection, and identity services (Azure AD, MFA, SSO) for a cloud-first SaaS organisation operating in the FinTech sector.
- Implemented security hardening across Microsoft 365 and Azure environments, reducing attack surface and improving regulatory compliance posture.
- Administered network security including firewall rules, VPN access controls, and endpoint protection configuration.
- Conducted security risk assessments, supported internal audits, and developed IT security policies aligned to ISO 27001 and CIS Controls.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Expert-level CrowdStrike Falcon deployment across 8,000 endpoints; built a hybrid SOC integrating NG-SIEM, EDR, and Microsoft Sentinel, measurably reducing threat dwell time.
- Designed Microsoft Sentinel workspace from scratch: 50+ analytics rules, automated Logic App playbooks, and executive workbook dashboards for SOC visibility.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) for 8,000 users, creating an integrated XDR capability.

- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM programme, achieving zero-standing-privilege posture across all administrative accounts.
- Led Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises, closing critical detection and prevention gaps confirmed by simulated adversary techniques.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification and progressed ISO 27001 alignment across the organisation.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 80,000 – 90,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)